



Figure 1: Welcome screen

lines of code shown below, locate and make the changes in the corresponding file, adjusting for your local set-up.

database.php (database-related configuration):

```
$db['default']['hostname'] = 'localhost'; # Server hostname.
$db['default']['username'] = 'databaseusername'; #Your DB
account username.
$db['default']['password'] = 'databasepassword'; #Database
password.
$db['default']['database'] = 'databasename'; #Database name.
$db['default']['dbdriver'] = 'mysql'; #Database driver.
```

autoload.php: This file automatically loads parameters at program start, saving you from having to constantly import these.

```
$autoload['libraries'] = array('database'); #auto-load database
library; others are session, email etc.
$autoload['helper'] = array('url', 'form'); #helper API (see
below).
```

Helpers are impressive APIs that speed up your work. There are many, like 'file', 'form', etc. We will talk about them later. If you want to learn more about helpers, refer to the user guide.

config.php (a general configuration file):

```
$config['base_url'] = 'http://localhost/ci2/'; #Default
CodeIgniter URL
$config['index_page'] = 'index.php'; #Default index
page.
```



Note: I recommend that you don't change the index page setting when you are new to the framework.

Let's roll

So, if you are all set, let's start with the traditional 'Hello World'. Let's create the main, required *Controller* file as *hello.php*, in the *application/controllers* sub-folder, with the following code:

```
// hello.php
<?php
class Hello extends CI_Controller { #1
    function index() { #2
        echo "Hello World";
    }
}
?>
```

Let's understand this code. The class name should have an initial upper-case letter (e.g., *Hello* as above) and ideally, should match the PHP file name. You must extend the *CI_Controller* class to associate your file to the URI (Uniform Resource Identifiers). The function *index()*, containing your simple code, is the default function that is executed. Now visit "*localhost/ci2/index.php/hello*" in your browser, to see 'Hello World' echoed.



Note: Since *index* is the default function, you don't need to include it in the URL—but to invoke some other function, say *abc()*, the URL would be "*localhost/ci2/index.php/hello/abc*".

Database test

Let's write a demo program to test database connectivity, in which you can create a table, insert records, fetch the records and display them in an HTML table. Let's use all three files, *Model*, *View* and *Controller* here; and create them with the exact paths given for each.